Made in His Image

Genesis 1:26–2:25 · Psalm 8

The big idea: Man and woman are made in God's image, to know him, reflect him, and care for his world. Work, marriage, and rest are his good gifts. Jesus is the true Image, and he restores ours.

Before you meet: Read

Genesis 1:26–2:25 | Psalm 8 | Colossians 1:15–17

Open (5 minutes)

What do people around you seem to think human beings are for? What would you have said a few years ago?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"So God created man in his own _____, in the image of God he created him; _____ and female he created them." *(Genesis 1:27)*

"Then the LORD God formed the man of _____ from the ground and breathed into his nostrils the _____ of life." *(Genesis 2:7)*

"The LORD God took the man and put him in the garden of Eden to _____ it and _____ it." *(Genesis 2:15)*

Discuss

1. Read Genesis 9:6 and James 3:9. How should God's image shape the way we treat the unborn, the disabled, the elderly, people of other races, and our enemies? *Genesis 9:6; James 3:9*

2. Work, marriage, and rest were all given before sin entered the world. Which of the three is hardest for you to receive as a gift? Why? *Genesis 2:2–3, 15, 18–24*

3. Hebrews admits, "At present, we do not yet see everything in subjection to him." Then it says, "But we see him." How is Jesus the answer to Psalm 8? *Psalm 8:3–6; Hebrews 2:8–9*

Memory verse

"So God created man in his own image, in the image of God he created him; male and female he created them."

Genesis 1:27

Pray

Thank God that he made you on purpose and in his image. Confess the ways you have defaced it. Ask him to make you more like Jesus, the true Image.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 6

Made in His Image

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Genesis 2:4–25 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the three fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Genesis 3:1–13).

Main points to land

1. Man and woman are made in God's image: to reflect his knowledge, righteousness, and holiness, to rule his world under him, and to bear the image together (Genesis 1:26–28; WSC 10). Every human life has dignity (Genesis 9:6).
2. In the garden God gave Adam work, a command, a wife, and rest. The command was the covenant of works, with Adam standing as head of the human race (Genesis 2:15–17; WCF 7.2).
3. We do not yet see the world under man's feet, but we see Jesus, the true Image, who restores God's image in all who trust him (Hebrews 2:8–9; Colossians 1:15; 2 Corinthians 3:18).

Core doctrine to teach

Creation and the Image of God CORE DOCTRINE 3 OF 26

God made everything out of nothing by his word, and it was very good. He made human beings, male and female, in his own image, to know him, reflect his character, and care for his world. Every human life carries that dignity. *Genesis 1:1, 26–28, 31; Psalm 8; Hebrews 11:3*

Answer key (Observe)

1. image; male
2. dust; breath
3. work; keep

Questions people will ask

Does everyone bear God's image, even people who reject him?

Yes. Genesis 9:6 and James 3:9 speak of God's image in people after the fall. Sin defaced the image but did not erase it. Only in Christ is it renewed in knowledge, righteousness, and holiness (Colossians 3:10; Ephesians 4:24). So every person has dignity, and every person needs Christ.

Closing prayer

Father, Son, and Holy Spirit, you made all things out of nothing, and you made us in your image to know you and to show your glory in your world. We confess that we have defaced that image. Thank you for Jesus, the true Image, who lived the life we were made for and died for our sin. Renew us after his likeness, and teach us to honor your image in every person we meet. Amen.